Date: **4/7/2026 4:38:04 PM**
From: **"Buddenhagen, Paul" PBuddenhagen@berkeleyca.gov**
To: **"All Employees" dlEmployees@berkeleyca.gov**
Subject: **April 15 Budget Reduction All Staff Webinar**

Dear COB Staff,

On Wednesday April 15 from 10 – noon, there will be an all-staff webinar with Mayor Ishii, DCM White, Budget Manager Dupaya, Finance Director Oyekanmi, HR Director Rodrigues and me, to provide information about the proposed budget reduction plan. You will receive a calendar invite with zoom link momentarily.

For some time now, it has been communicated that the City is experiencing a sizable structural budget deficit. This deficit is most significantly in the General Fund, but other funds are impacted as well, such as the Marina Fund, Parking Funds, Building Maintenance Fund, Mental/Behavioral Health Special Funds, and the Capital Improvement Fund. As indicated in previous messages, rather than relying on one-time fixes to address the City's long-term fiscal challenges, the proposed Budget Balancing Plan proposes workforce reductions, non-personnel expenditure reductions, and cost shifts to restore fiscal stability and reduce the likelihood of having to go through this again in the near future. This is a painful reality that unfortunately we must face.

The proposed Budget Reduction Plan will be publicly available on Tuesday April 14, 2026, and can be found on the Budget and Finance Policy Committee's webpage here:

https://berkeleyca.gov/your-government/city-council/council-committees/policy-committee-budget-finance

This plan will include a list of positions proposed to be removed from the budget, by department -- most vacant, but some filled -- as well as non personnel and contract reductions, and cost shifts. The purpose of the webinar is to present that information to all staff and answer questions so that everyone has as much clarity as possible about the rationale for reductions, the specific proposed reductions, impacts on services, and the timeline for the many next steps. This is a hard time for us which makes it especially important that we come together as an organization and take care of one another. I, and all of our Department Directors, are available to listen to your concerns and to answer your questions to the best of our ability. I will continue to send regular communications to everyone as we move forward.

Thank you,
Paul

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